ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 68

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Zulu Alphabet

Izinhlamvu zesiZulu

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 33 Zulu Letters with English Phonetics

A a B b C c

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Zulu Alphabet — Izinhlamvu zesiZulu
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 68

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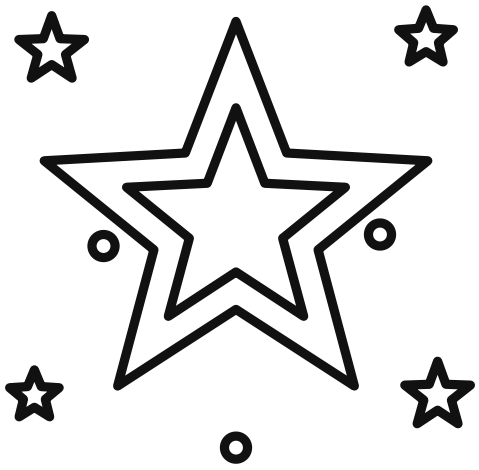
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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



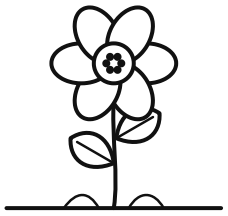
This book belongs to

Le ncwadi ingeka

I started learning Zulu on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 68 is Zulu. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **CAPITALS** show the stressed syllable: in Zulu it is nearly always the second-to-last one, *ee-[q]AHN-dah*.
- **[c] [q] [x]** mean: make that **click** (see "Three clicks" before the letter pages).
- **hl** is a hissing 'l' and **dl** a buzzing 'l'; in the pronunciation, **t**, **k** and **p** are never 'th' or 'f'.
- **ee** says 'ee' as in "see", **oo** says 'oo' as in "moon", **oh** says 'o' as in "go", **eh** says 'e' as in "bed".

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Zulu name** written in Zulu (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Zulu letter name · syllables* shows how Zulu children say the letter (B is «ba», C is «ca»…) and its row of syllables, the way they learn to read.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Standard written Zulu.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Zulu! isiZulu

ee-see-ZOO-loo — the Zulu word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **28 million people** speak isiZulu, at home or as a second language.[3]

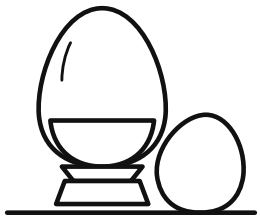
Where?
Mostly in **South Africa**, especially around **Durban** and **Johannesburg**, and in neighbouring countries.

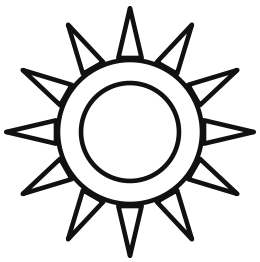
How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**.

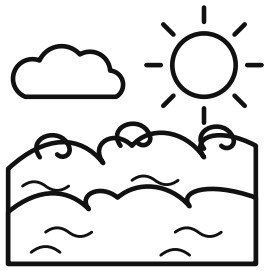
How many letters?
26 letters, plus letter pairs such as **hl**, **dl** and **ph** that make one sound.

Clicks!
C, **Q** and **X** are **click sounds**. Say *iqanda* (egg) with a pop!

Did you know?
izulu means **sky**. And in isiZulu the word for zero is *iqanda* — the same word as “egg”, because a zero is shaped like an egg!







The Zulu Alphabet izinhlamvu

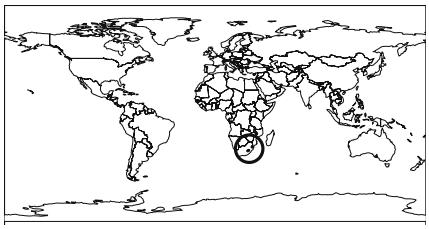
26 letters — izinhlamvu

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *bah*	**Cc** *[c]ah*	**Dd** *dah*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *fah*	**Gg** *gah*
Hh *hah*	**Ii** *ee*	**Jj** *jah*	**Kk** *kah*	**Ll** *lah*	**Mm** *mah*	**Nn** *nah*
Oo *oh*	**Pp** *pah*	**Qq** *[q]ah*	**Rr** *rah*	**Ss** *sah*	**Tt** *tah*	**Uu** *oo*
Vv *vah*	**Ww** *wah*	**Xx** *[x]ah*	**Yy** *yah*	**Zz** *zah*		

7 letter pairs — bh · dl · hl · kh · ny · ph · th

Bh bh *bah*	**Dl dl** *dlah*	**Hl hl** *hlah*	**Kh kh** *kah*	**Ny ny** *nyah*	**Ph ph** *pah*	**Th th** *tah*

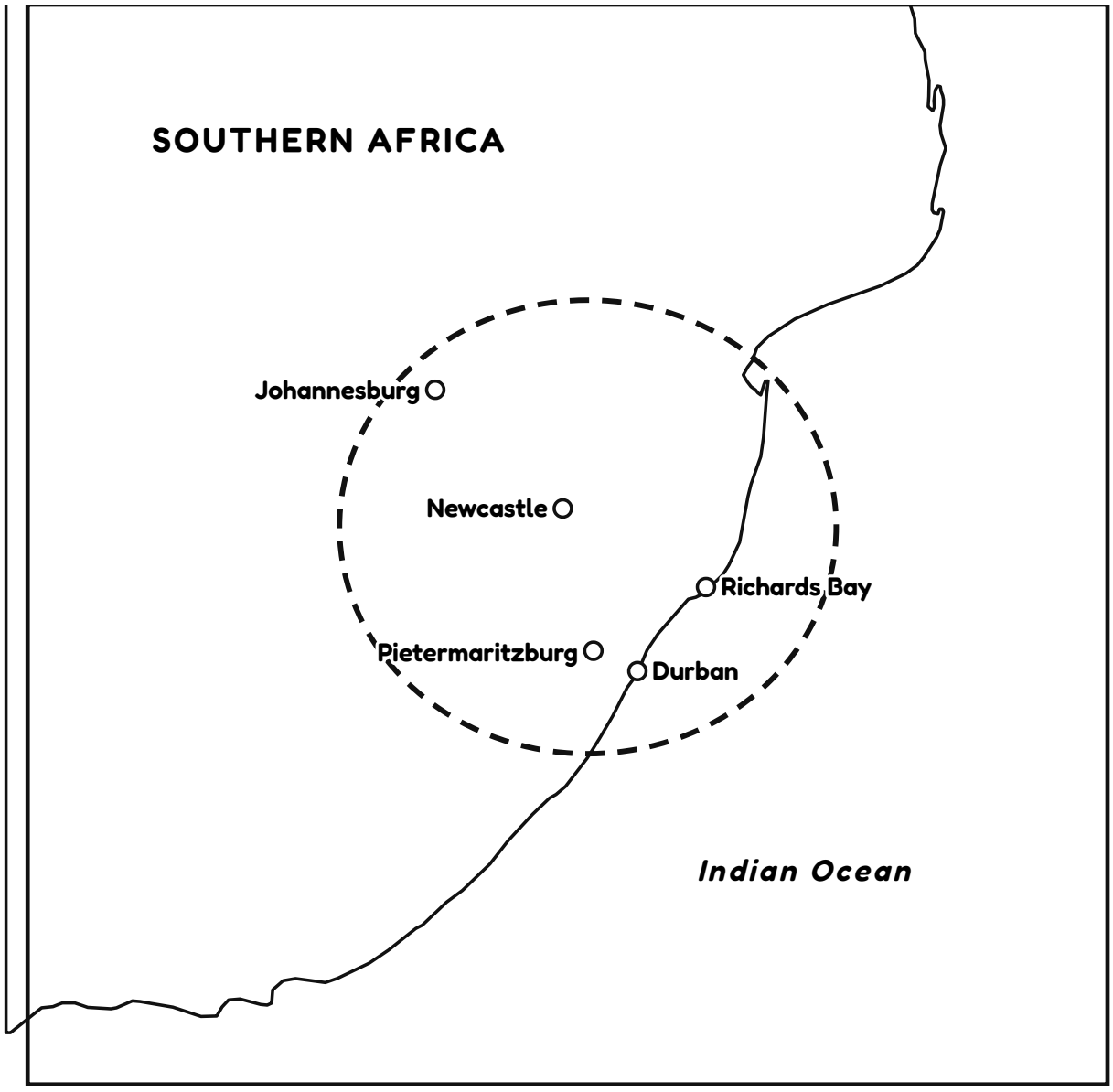
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows southern Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Zulu spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** the dashed line shows where most Zulu speakers live, around Durban, Pietermaritzburg, Richards Bay and Newcastle, up to Johannesburg.

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The Letters izinhlamvu

ee-zeen-HLAHM-voo — “the letters”

isiZulu uses the same **26 letters** as English. A few of them make very different sounds!

Three clicks: C · Q · X
C — the “tsk-tsk” click: pull your tongue tip back from your top teeth.
Q — the “pop” click: pop your tongue off the roof of your mouth, like a cork.
X — the side click: click the side of your tongue, like calling a horse.
In the sound guides, **[c] [q] [x]** mean: make the click!

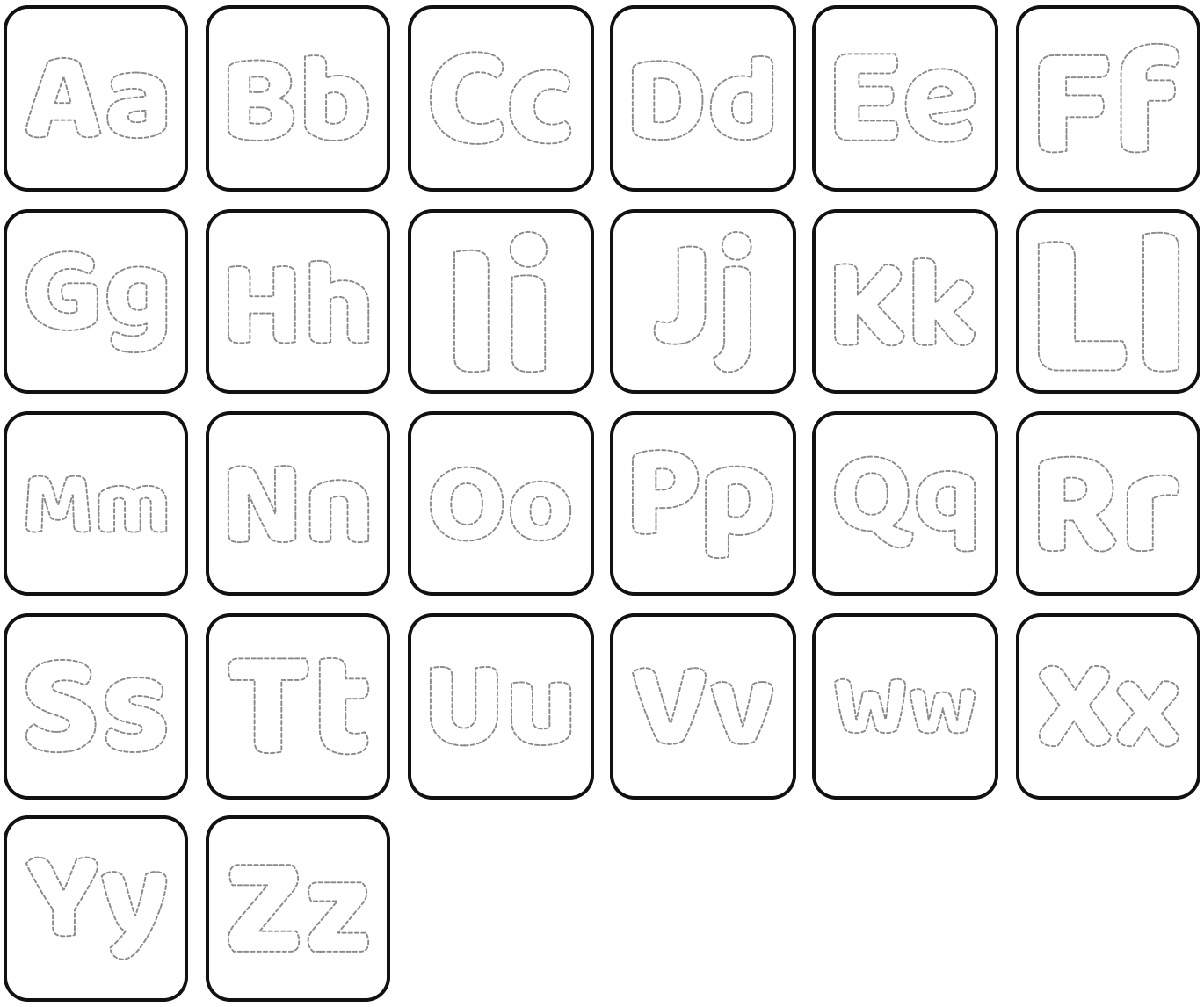
Look past the prefix
Zulu words begin with a small part such as **i-**, **u-**, **isi-** or **um-**: *i*-qanda (egg), *isi*-cathulo (shoe). The letter you are learning is underlined in each word.

Ba, be, bi, bo, bu
Every Zulu syllable ends in a vowel. Every page shows the letter’s row: *ba · be · bi · bo · bu*. Say it like a song!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters izinhlamvu

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · IGAMA

a

ah

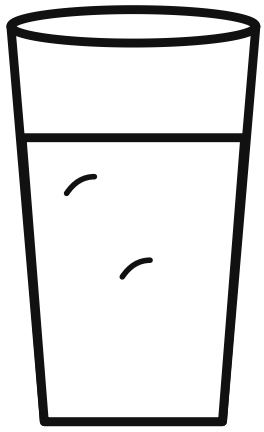
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

A a — «a»

ba · da · ka · la · ma



AA IS FOR

amanzi

ah-MAHN-zee

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Aa Aa Aa Aa

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Bb

NAME · IGAMA

ba

bah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘b’, said while breathing in a little

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

B b — «ba»

ba · be · bi · bo · bu

B on its own is a soft, ‘swallowed’ b. **BH** is the ordinary ‘b’ of English.



BB IS FOR

ubisi

oo-BEE-see

milk

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Bb Bb Bb Bb

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Cc

NAME · IGAMA

ca

[c]ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

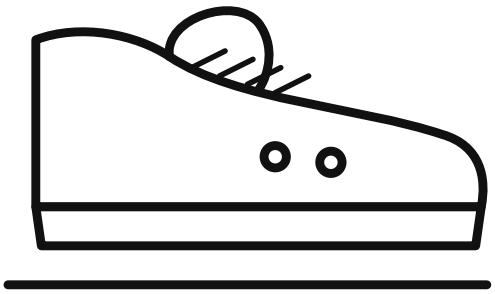
a **click**! Pull the tip of your tongue back from your top teeth: “tsk!”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

C c — «ca»

ca · ce · ci · co · cu

The **tsk-tsk** click, like saying “what a pity!”



CC IS FOR

isicathulo

ee-see-[c]ah-TOO-loh

shoe

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Cc Cc Cc Cc

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Dd

NAME · IGAMA

da

dah

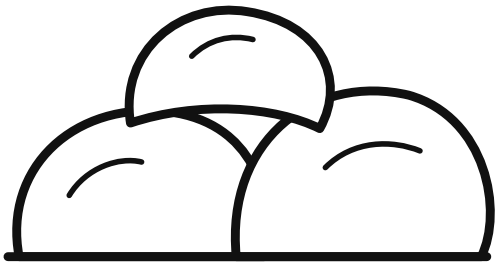
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

D d — «da»

da · de · di · do · du



DD IS FOR

idwala

ee-DWAH-lah

rock · big stone

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Dd Dd Dd Dd

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Ee

NAME · IGAMA

e

eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “bed”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

E e — «e»

be · de · ke · le · me

Zulu words hardly ever start with E. Find it inside *ikhekhe*!



EE IS FOR

ikhekhe

ee-KEH-keh

cake

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ee Ee Ee Ee

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Ff

NAME · IGAMA

fa

fah

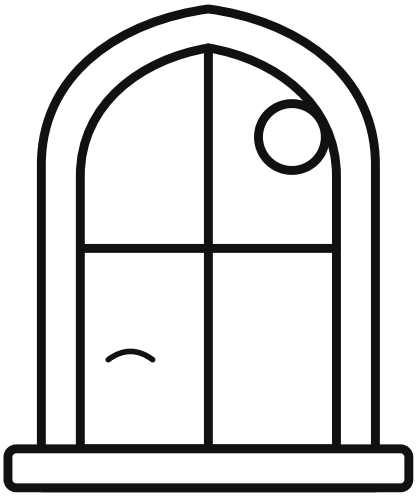
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

F f — «fa»

fa · fe · fi · fo · fu



FF IS FOR

ifasitela

ee-fah-see-TEH-lah

window

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ff Ff Ff Ff

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Gg

NAME · IGAMA

ga

gah

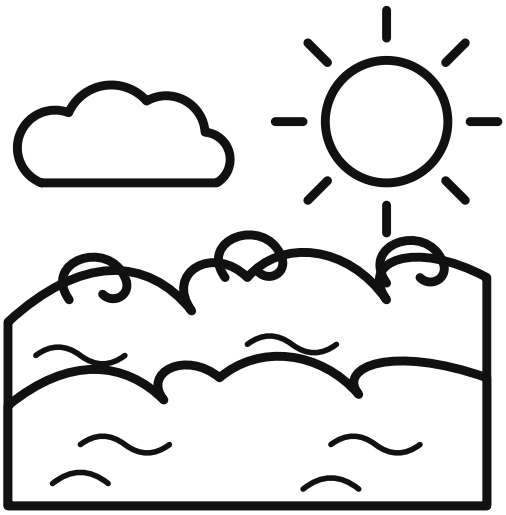
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

G g — «ga»

ga · ge · gi · go · gu



GG IS FOR

igagasi

ee-gah-GAH-see

wave

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Gg Gg Gg Gg

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Hh

NAME · IGAMA

ha

hah

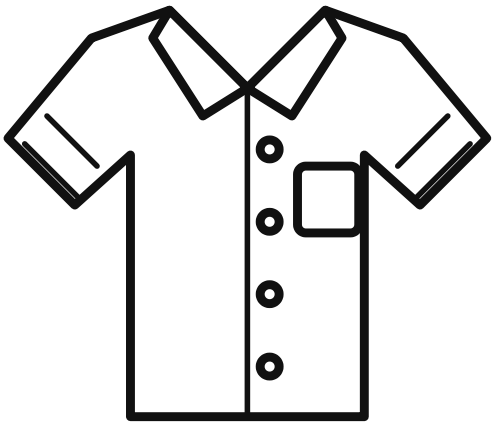
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

H h — «ha»

ha · he · hi · ho · hu



HH IS FOR

ihembe

ee-HEM-beh

shirt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Hh Hh Hh Hh

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Ii

NAME · IGAMA

i

ee

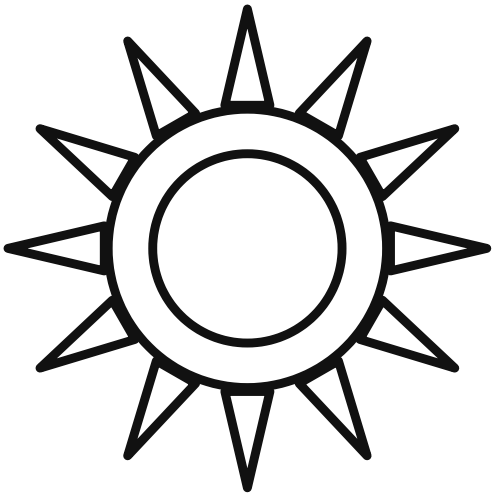
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

| i — «i»

bi · di · ki · li · mi



II IS FOR

ilanga

ee-LAHN-gah

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

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Jj

NAME · IGAMA

ja

jah

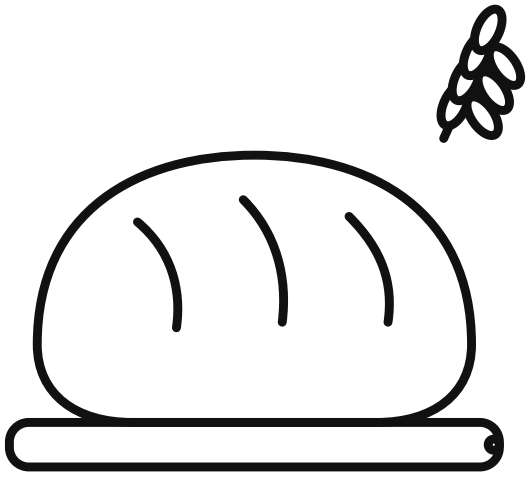
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

J j — «ja»

ja · je · ji · jo · ju



JJ IS FOR

ujeqe

oo-JEH-[q]eh

steamed bread

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Jj Jj Jj Jj

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Kk

NAME · IGAMA

ka

kah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

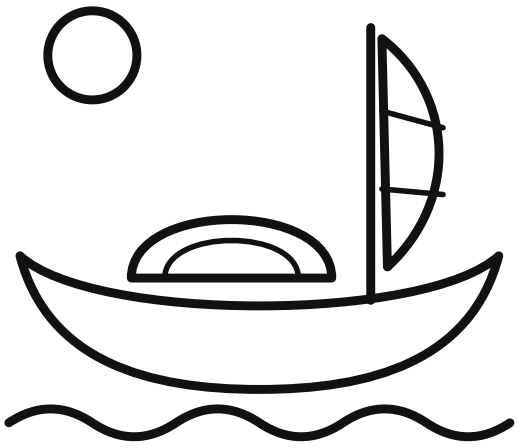
a soft ‘k’ (no puff of air)

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

K k — «ka»

ka · ke · ki · ko · ku

K is soft; **KH** is a ‘k’ with a puff of air.



KK IS FOR

isikebhe

ee-see-KEH-beh

boat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Kk Kk Kk Kk

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Ll

NAME · IGAMA

la

lah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

L l — «la»

la · le · li · lo · lu



LL IS FOR

ilayisi

ee-lah-YEE-see

rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ll Ll Ll Ll Ll

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Mm

NAME · IGAMA

ma

mah

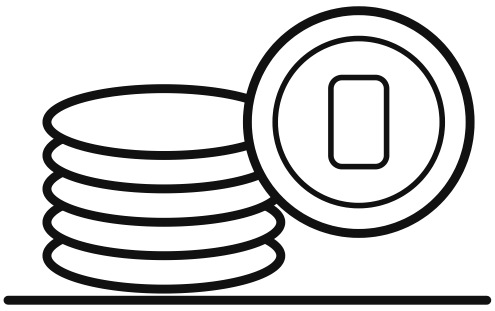
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

M m — «ma»

ma · me · mi · mo · mu



MM IS FOR

imali

ee-MAH-lee

money

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Mm Mm Mm Mm

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Nn

NAME · IGAMA

na

nah

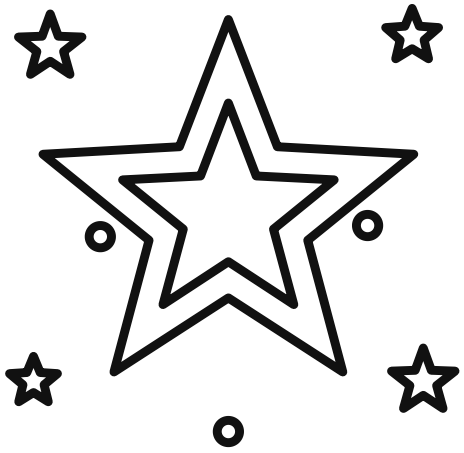
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

N n — «na»

na · ne · ni · no · nu



NN IS FOR

inkanyezi

een-kah-NYEH-zee

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Nn Nn Nn Nn

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Oo

NAME · IGAMA

o

oh

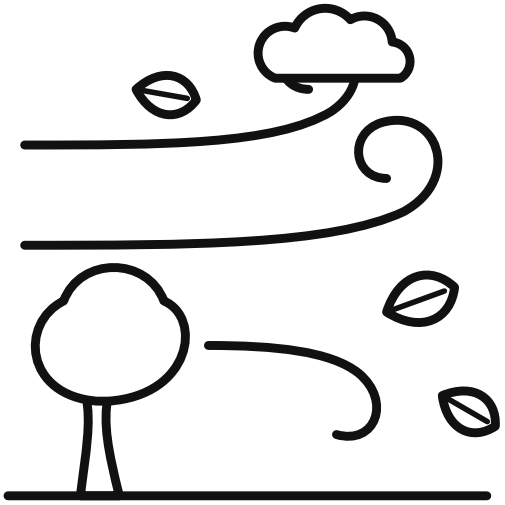
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “for” (short and pure)

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

O o — «o»

bo · do · ko · lo · mo



OO IS FOR

umoya

oo-MOH-yah

wind · air

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Oo Oo Oo Oo

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Pp

NAME · IGAMA

pa

pah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

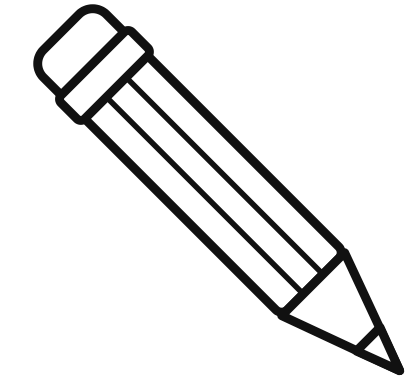
a soft ‘p’ (no puff of air)

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

P p — «pa»

pa · pe · pi · po · pu

P is soft; **PH** is a ‘p’ with a puff of air.



PP IS FOR

ipensela

ee-pen-SEH-lah

pencil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Pp Pp Pp Pp

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Qq

NAME · IGAMA

qa

[q]ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

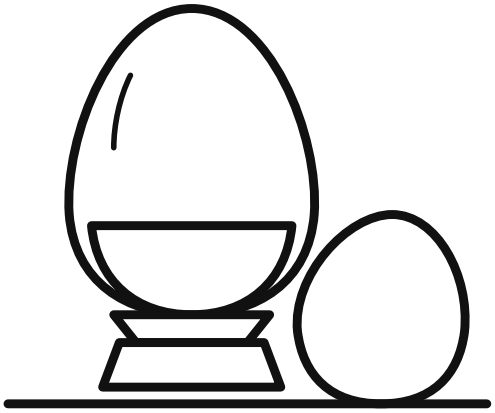
a **click**! Pop your tongue off the roof of your mouth, like a cork

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Q q — «qa»

qa · qe · qi · qo · qu

The loud **pop** click, like a bottle opening.



QQ IS FOR

iqanda

ee-[q]AHN-dah

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Qq Qq Qq Qq

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Rr

NAME · IGAMA

ra

rah

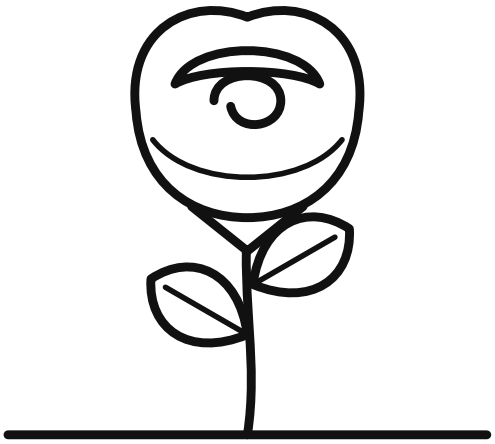
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'r' — used mostly in words borrowed from other languages

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

R r — «ra»

ra · re · ri · ro · ru



RR IS FOR

irozi

ee-ROH-zee

rose

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Rr Rr Rr Rr

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Ss Ss

NAME · IGAMA

sa

sah

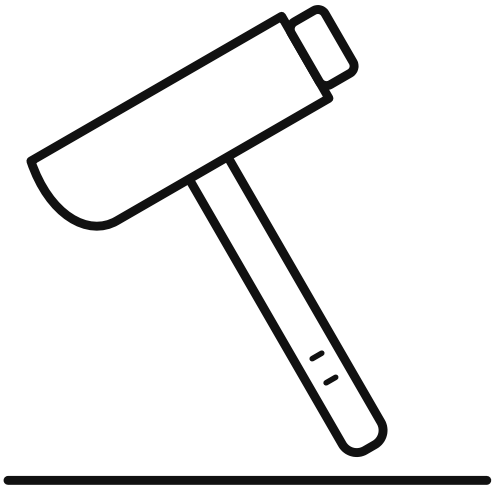
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

S s — «sa»

sa · se · si · so · su



SS IS FOR

isando

ee-SAHN-doh

hammer

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ss Ss Ss Ss

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Tt

NAME · IGAMA

ta

tah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

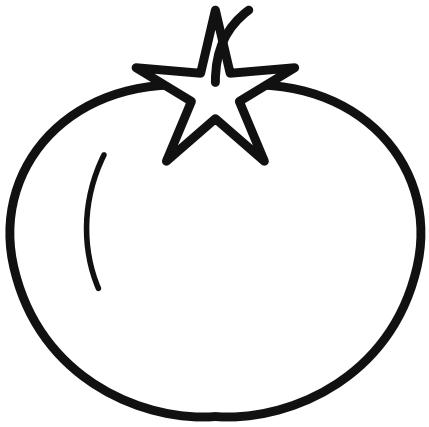
a soft ‘t’ (no puff of air)

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

T t — «ta»

ta · te · ti · to · tu

T is soft; **TH** is a ‘t’ with a puff of air — never the ‘th’ of “think”.



TT IS FOR

utamatisi

oo-tah-mah-TEE-see

tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Tt Tt Tt Tt

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Uu

NAME · IGAMA

u

oo

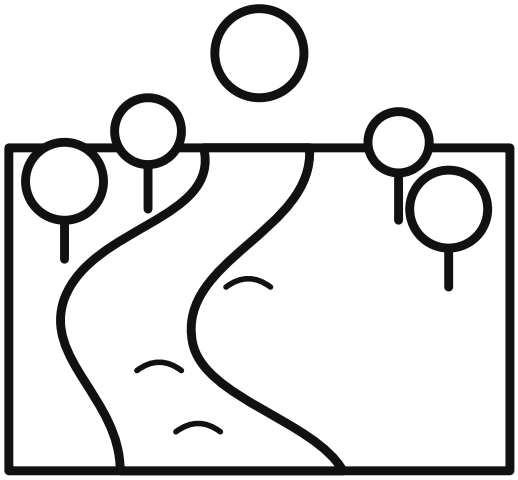
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

U u — «u»

bu · du · ku · lu · mu



UU IS FOR

umfula

oom-FOO-lah

river

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Uu Uu Uu Uu

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Vv

NAME · IGAMA

va

vah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘v’ as in “van”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

V v — «va»

va · ve · vi · vo · vu



VV IS FOR

imvula

eem-VOO-lah

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Vv Vv Vv Vv

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Ww

NAME · IGAMA

wa

wah

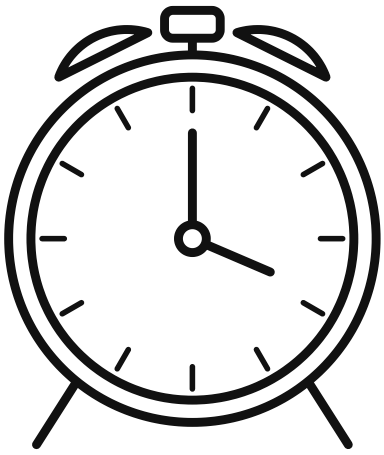
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

W w — «wa»

wa · we · wi · wo · wu



WW **IS FOR**

iwashi

ee-WAH-shee

watch · clock

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ww Ww Ww Ww

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Xx

NAME · IGAMA

xa

[x]ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

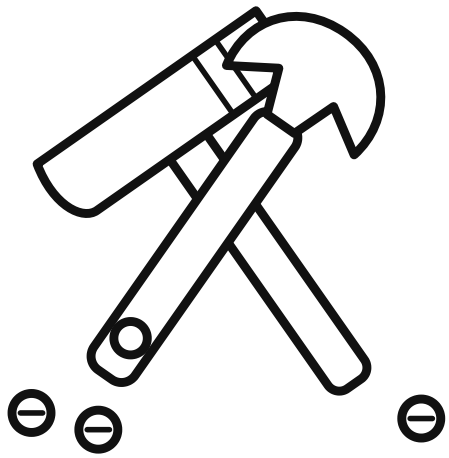
a **click**! Click the side of your tongue, like calling a horse

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

X x — «xa»

xa · xe · xi · xo · xu

The side click, made at the side of the mouth. In Zulu X is **never** ‘ks’!



XX **IS FOR**

isixhobo

ee-see-[x]OH-boh

tool

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Xx Xx Xx Xx

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Yy

NAME · IGAMA

ya

yah

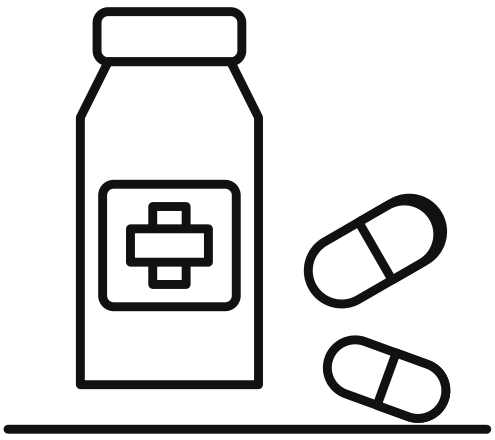
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Y y — «ya»

ya · ye · yi · yo · yu



YY IS FOR

iyeza

ee-YEH-zah

medicine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Yy Yy Yy Yy

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Zz

NAME · IGAMA

za

zah

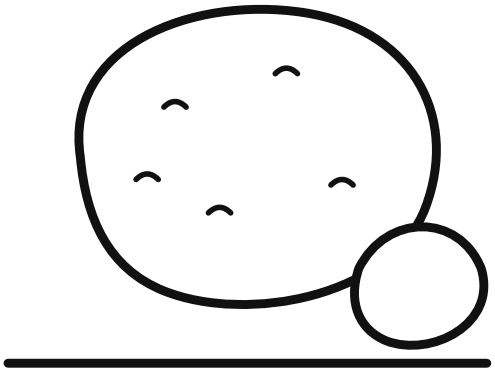
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Z z — «za»

za · ze · zi · zo · zu



ZZ IS FOR

izambane

ee-zahm-BAH-neh

potato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Zz Zz Zz Zz

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LETTER PAIRS

Letter Pairs bh · dl · hl · kh · ny · ph · th

seven pairs that make one sound each

Some Zulu sounds are written with **two letters**. Each pair is **one sound**.

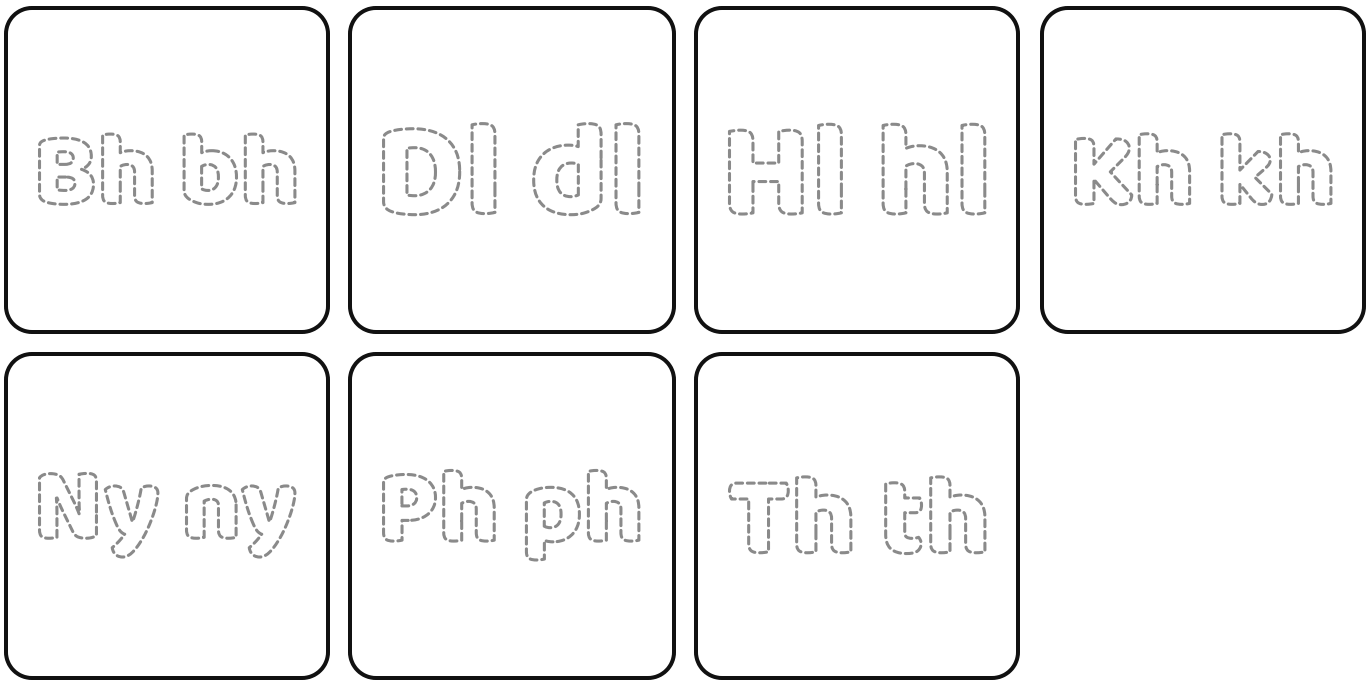
A puff of air
An **H** after a letter often adds a puff of air: **KH PH TH**. So **PH** is never ‘f’ and **TH** is never the ‘th’ of “think”.

Two special sounds: HL and DL
HL is a hissing ‘l’ and **DL** a buzzing ‘l’: let the air slide past the sides of your tongue. Zulu children say them in *ihlathi* (forest) and *indlu* (house).

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letter pairs bh · dl · hl · kh · ny · ph · th

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Bh bh

NAME · IGAMA

bha

bah

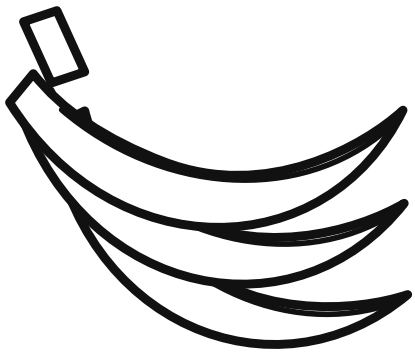
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Bh bh — «bha»

bha · bhe · bhi · bho · bhu



BH BH IS FOR

ibhanana

ee-bah-NAH-nah

banana

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Bh bh Bh bh Bh bh Bh bh

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Dl dl

NAME · IGAMA

dla

dlah

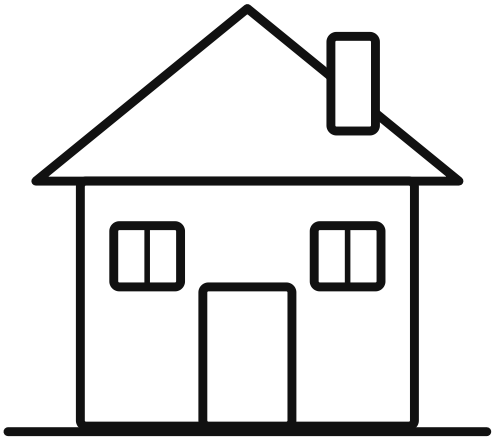
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a buzzing ‘l’: say ‘d’ and ‘l’ together, with air at the sides of the tongue

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Dl dl — «dla»

dla · dle · dli · dlo · dlu



DL DL IS FOR

indlu

EEN-dloo

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Dl dl Dl dl Dl dl Dl dl

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Hl hl

NAME · IGAMA

hla

hlah

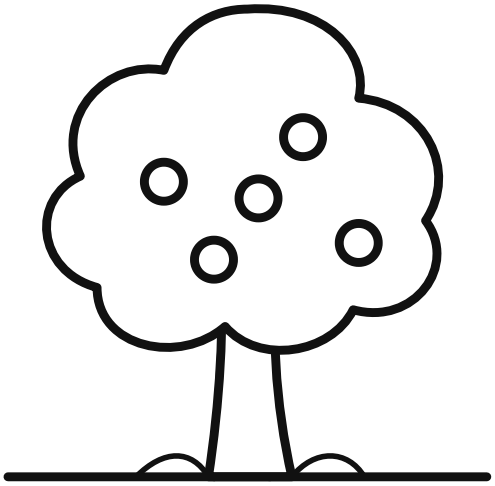
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hissing ‘l’: blow air past the sides of your tongue (like Welsh “ll”)

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Hl hl — «hla»

hla · hle · hli · hlo · hlu



HL HL IS FOR

ihlathi

ee-HLAH-tee

forest

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Hl hl Hl hl Hl hl Hl hl

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Kh kh

NAME · IGAMA

kha

kah

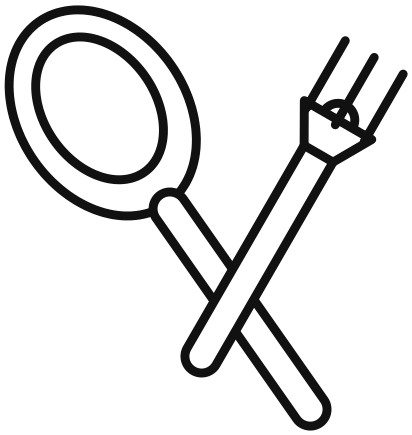
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ with a puff of air, as in “kite”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Kh kh — «kha»

kha · khe · khi · kho · khu



KH KH IS FOR

ukhezo

oo-KEH-zoh

spoon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Kh kh Kh kh Kh kh Kh kh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ny ny

NAME · IGAMA

nya

nyah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ny’ as in “canyon”

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Ny ny — «nya»

nya · nye · nyi · nyo · nyu



NY NY IS FOR

inyanga

ee-NYAHN-gah

moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny

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Ph ph

NAME · IGAMA

pha

pah

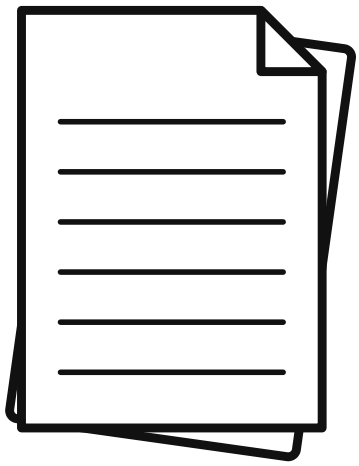
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ with a puff of air, as in “pen” — not ‘f’!

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Ph ph — «pha»

pha · phe · phi · pho · phu



PH PH IS FOR

iphepha

ee-PEH-pah

paper

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

Ph ph Ph ph Ph ph Ph ph

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Th th

NAME · IGAMA

tha

tah

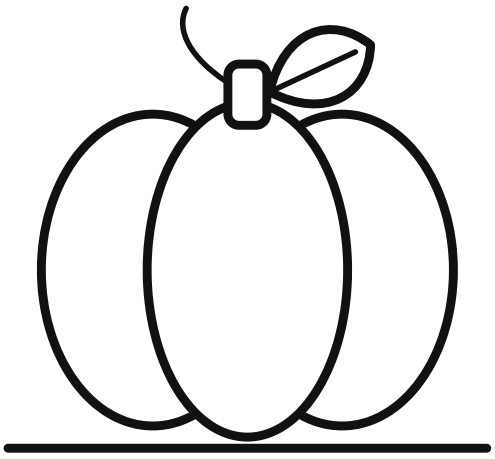
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ with a puff of air, as in “tap” — not ‘th’!

ZULU LETTER NAME · SYLLABLES

Th th — «tha»

tha · the · thi · tho · thu



TH TH IS FOR

ithanga

ee-TAHN-gah

pumpkin

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BHALA

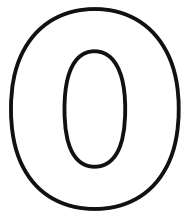
Th th Th th Th th Th th

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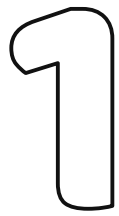
BONUS

Zulu numbers izinombolo *(ee-zee-nohm-BOH-loh)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Zulu: *ee-[q]AHN-dah, KOO-nyeh, koo-BEE-lee, koo-TAH-too...*



0
iqanda
ee-[q]AHN-dah
zero



1
kunye
KOO-nyeh
one



2
kubili
koo-BEE-lee
two



3
kuthathu
koo-TAH-too
three



4
kune
KOO-neh
four



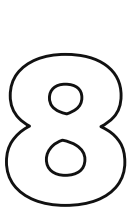
5
kuhlanu
koo-HLAH-noo
five



6
isithupha
ee-see-TOO-pah
six



7
isikhombisa
ee-see-kohm-BEE-sah
seven



8
isishiyagalombili
ee-see-shee-yah-gah-lohm-BEE-lee
eight



9
isishiyagalolunye
ee-see-shee-yah-gah-loh-LOO-nyeh
nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Zulu words Amagama okuqala

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalaamu alaykum
as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAY-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

Wa alaykum assalaam
wah ah-LAY-koom as-sah-LAHM
And upon you be peace (the reply)

Sawubona!
sah-woo-BOH-nah
Hello! (to one person)

Igama lami ngu...
ee-GAH-mah LAH-mee ngoo...
My name is ...

Ngiyabonga
ngee-yah-BOHN-gah
Thank you

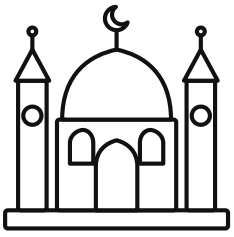
Jazaakallaahu khayran
jah-zaa-kal-LAA-hoo KHAY-ran
May Allah reward you with good

umama · ubaba
oo-MAH-mah · oo-BAH-bah
Mother · Father

umfowethu · udadewethu
oom-foh-WEH-too · oo-dah-deh-WEH-too
My brother · My sister

yebo · cha
YEH-boh · [c]ah
Yes · No

Ngifunda isiZulu!
ngee-FOON-dah ee-see-ZOO-loo
I am learning Zulu!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

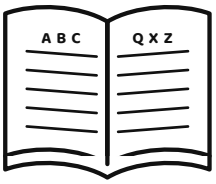
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

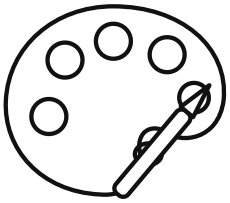
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International).

What's next?
You have met all **33 Zulu letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Zulu, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! Wenze kahle!

mah-SHAH-lah! WEN-zeh KAH-hleh — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 33 letters of the Zulu alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author



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✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.